

Clause Patterns Worksheet

Exercise 1 Find the clause pattern in each sentence and label the elements. Use only these patterns: **S V IO DO**, **S V SP**, and **S V DO OP**. Add adverbials where relevant.

- 1) She gave the child a pencil.
- 2) The old woman in the corner was surprisingly cheerful after lunch.
- 3) They elected him president.
- 4) Our teacher gave us extra homework yesterday.
- 5) The sky above the harbour was completely clear.
- 6) The committee elected Maria chair last spring.
- 7) His uncle gave the twins a very noisy toy for Christmas.
- 8) The students at the back were unusually quiet during the film.
- 9) The club elected Jonas treasurer after a short debate.
- 10) My neighbour gave her daughter a small box of chocolates.
- 11) Their new puppy was full of energy all morning.
- 12) The class elected Emma spokesperson for the project.
- 13) The librarian gave me a copy of the article before lunch.
- 14) Her explanation of the problem was clear to everyone.
- 15) The voters elected their youngest candidate mayor in 2019.
- 16) My brother gave our guests fresh coffee in the garden.
- 17) The children in the playground were very happy after the rain stopped.
- 18) The board elected him vice-president for another year.
- 19) The guide gave the tourists a map of the old city.
- 20) Their final answer was wrong at first.

Exercise 2 Find the clause pattern in the bold part of each famous opening line. Label the elements and note whether the pattern is **S V IO DO**, **S V SP**, or **S V DO OP**.

- 1) William Gibson, *Neuromancer*: “**The sky above the port was the color of television**, tuned to a dead channel.”

- 2) Leo Tolstoy, *Anna Karenina*: “**Happy families are all alike**; every unhappy family is unhappy in its own way.”
- 3) Ralph Ellison, *Invisible Man*: “**I am an invisible man.**”
- 4) Toni Morrison, *Beloved*: “**124 was spiteful**. Full of a baby’s venom.”
- 5) Dodie Smith, *I Capture the Castle*: “**I write this sitting in the kitchen sink.**”
- 6) J. R. R. Tolkien, *The Hobbit*: “In a hole in the ground there lived a hobbit.”
Rewrite the clause in normal word order and then label the elements.
- 7) Charles Dickens, *David Copperfield*: “**Whether I shall turn out to be the hero of my own life**”, or whether that station will be held by anybody else, these pages must show. Find the pattern in the bold clause after “to be”.
- 8) Charlotte Brontë, *Jane Eyre*: “**There was no possibility of taking a walk that day.**” Find the pattern in the main clause.

Exercise 3 For each pattern, choose two clauses from exercise 1 or 2 and explain briefly why the noun phrases are **IO + DO**, **SP**, or **DO + OP**.

- 1) Write one short test you can use for **IO**.
- 2) Write one short test you can use for **OP**.
- 3) Write one example of your own for each of the three patterns.